Take The Lead

CS 411W

Old Dominion University

Version 2

Take The Lead

Lab 1(Draft 1) Descriptive Paper

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1 Introduction

This project will address the misunderstanding between veterinarians, the cost of services for pets, and pet assistance at large. As of 3/12/2026, there are approximately 94 million homes that own, at minimum, one pet. Estimated, approximately ~6.4 million of those pets are insured. This is an increase from previous years but still does not acknowledge the pet health industry at large. This project, titled "Take The Lead," will work with pet hospitals (ER and regular veterinary offices) by creating a 30-day donation campaign run by the Member to generate funds while the hospital either acknowledges a delay in payment or Take The Lead pays the funding up front to allow the pet to receive immediate and often times critically necessary care. During the 30 days, it is the responsibility of the story creator to share the link to the campaign to generate revenue to pay for services. At the termination of the campaign, all proceeds go toward paying the bill with Take The Lead either sending a check to the hospital or Take The Lead receiving the proceeds. Any excess goes towards the Member and anything remaining becomes the Member's responsibility and is due immediately or risks involving collections and potentially a legal entity. Take The Lead will have a secondary focus on information via additional links that will inform families about pet insurance, what questions to (or not) ask, why veterinarian services are necessary *and* expensive, the suicide rate of veterinarians which currently sits at 1.6 times the rate of the population for men and 2.4 times the rate of the population more likely for female veterinarians than the general population and this is likely due to compassion fatigue (CDC). There are assistance options out there, and the goal is to provide people with that information *before* they agree to make a campaign because, again, the remaining balance is immediately due. AI will be introduced in the form of a direct chatbot that can help direct traffic to helpful links, phone numbers, and application-provided information.

In summary, Take The Lead is the solution to the problem of affording emergent and standard animal care while also providing supporting documents to help veterinarians and their clientele remain

educated. Information on insurance and additional financial services will be provided to support the continued health and wellbeing of their pet. Take The Lead will address this societal problem by providing a 30-day campaign (with a 48 hour creation window) generated and run by Members of the website application and by potentially providing starting payment so a pet can be seen and treated as soon as possible.

2 Take The Lead Product Description

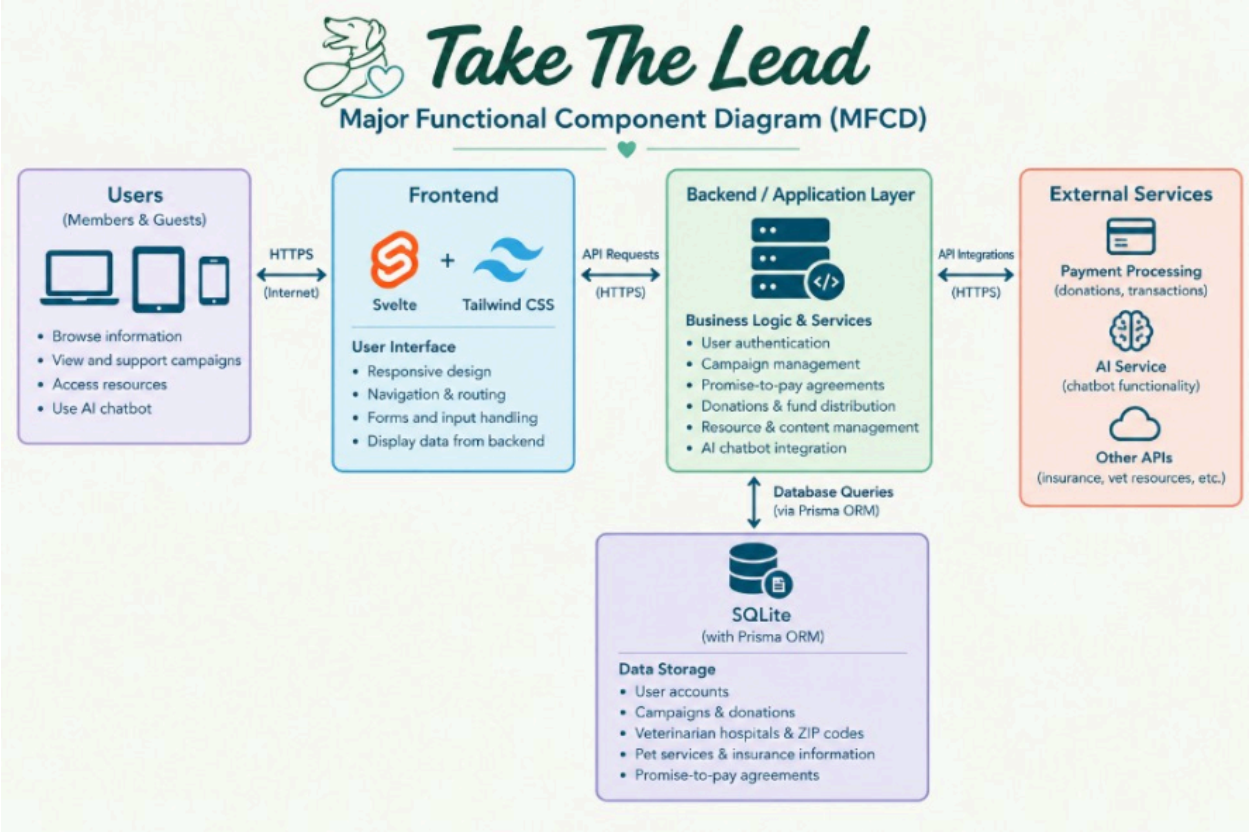
Take The Lead, a website application, will aid families by providing a Promise to Pay or a Minimum Down Payment to Vet hospitals while giving family members (or just Members) a 30 day window to procure additional funding either through our donation service or through additional means. Members can run the Story for 30 days by sharing it on their social media platforms via a link which will allow friends/family members/acquaintances to donate to the campaign. After the 30-day campaign ends, funds generated go immediately to paying Take The Lead if we supplied a minimum down payment, then to the veterinarian hospital and lastly will be given to the Member to make the decision to a) keep the funds or b) donate the funds back to us in a recursive revenue process. If a campaign does not generate sufficient funds, the remaining payments are due to us (if minimum down payment supplied) and/or the veterinarian hospital. In order to assist Members with remaining due, we will offer additional reading and learning material in the form of why services are necessary and why their expense is *not* the fault of the staff, a desire to increase compassion for veterinarian staff by sharing suicide and self-harm rates, providing information on pet insurance and pet-only credit cards.

2.1 Key Product Features and Capabilities

Take The Lead is a website application that works in tandem with veterinary hospitals to ensure pets can receive immediate care by paying for upfront or entering an agreement with the hospital for a 30-day period while the Member generates additional funding. Rather than be a crutch, Take The Lead will also supply information on insurance with the potential of partnering with insurance companies, drive an increase in compassion for clients towards the veterinarian staff by suppling information on the alarming suicide rates, debt to income ratio, and importance of services (such as regular checkups) which drives up revenue for hospitals that previously only see animals on an urgent/emergency basis and lastly will provide information on (and again, potentially partner with) pet insurance and pet-only credit lines.

2.2 Major Components (Hardware/Software)

HTML (JSX file, .css, JavaScript)



4 Glossary

Member – A user with a registered account of the web application “Take The Lead.”

Story – The 30 day campaign that a Member will run, interchangeable with “campaign.”

Preventative Care – Animal care that is to prevent illness. Examples of this are vaccines, check-ups, x-rays of older animals’ joints, etc. This is also termed ***wellness care***.

TTL - short-hand for the company Take The Lead

ER - short-hand for “Emergency Room”

MFCD - Major Functional Component Diagram: a diagram showing the pieces necessary for the designed program to function at minimum

“Promise to Pay” - A formal commitment where a person or business agrees to pay a specific amount of money to another party by an agreed deadline.

5 References

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More information:

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Website: https://teach210.github.io/take-the-lead/